

INFORMED CONSENT

STUDY TITLE: Integrating Interaction, Embodiment, and Emotion to Transform Language Models

Principal researcher: Dr. Casey Kennington

Protocol Number: IRB24-222

Dear participant,

We are members of the SLIM group from the Computer Science Department at Boise State University. Our research is in the field of Natural Language Processing, which concerns the ability of a computer application to understand human speech as it is spoken. We are conducting this research study to collect data to evaluate how people interact with Cozmo or Misty, both robots we have programmed to navigate the world.

This consent form will make you aware of all the things that you should know before deciding to participate. After reading this form you will understand why this research study is being done and why you are being invited to participate. You will also know of any risks, inconveniences or discomforts that you may have while participating and what can be done for that. I encourage you to ask questions at any time. If you decide to participate, you will be asked to sign this form and it will be a record of your agreement to participate.

• WHAT THE STUDY IS ABOUT

The purpose of this study is to collect data to evaluate what a robot must be capable of doing in order to successfully navigate the world. To do this analysis, we need people like you to spend time with the robot and tell us what you think.

• WHAT WE WILL ASK YOU TO DO

You will interact with the robot directly. This will involve performing a task for at least a for two separate periods of about 25 minutes, and then answering the anonymous questionnaire at the end of each of those two periods. These interactions will be recorded for video and audio. You

may be quoted in a future publication. No information from your interactions will be made publicly available that could be used to identify you.

Your answers to our questions will help us learn about how to improve human-robot interaction in the future. Your participation in this study is voluntary. If you choose not to participate or to withdraw from the study at any time, you can do so and there will be no penalties. If at any time you discontinue the study, your results will be discarded. The results of the research study may be published, but your name will not be used.

Details of the task will be covered in the Debriefing Statement.

• REQUIREMENTS

You must have native or near-native English speaking proficiency.

• RISKS

This study requires you to interact with a robot. There will be an audio and video recording of the interaction. No recordings will be shared outside of the research group.

In the unlikely event that the interaction makes you uncomfortable or upset, you are always free to stop your participation at any time by leaving the room. Should you feel discomfort after participating and you are a Boise State University student, you may contact the University Health Services (UHS) for counseling services at (208) 426-1459. They are located on campus in the Norco Building, 1529 Belmont Street, Boise ID, 83706. You may also contact the investigator at any time to discard your session from further use.

If you are a non-BSU student and you experience any discomfort from participation in this study, please contact your local primary healthcare provider. If you do not have one, The Friendship Clinic is a free Boise clinic located at 704 South Latah, Boise, ID 83705, (208)429-6678. If you are in distress you can contact the Idaho Suicide Hotline: 1-800-564-2120, the National Suicide Hotline: 1-800-273-8255, or the National Crisis Text Line: text "START" to 741-741. You may also contact the investigator at any time to discard your session from further use.

• YOUR ANSWERS WILL BE CONFIDENTIAL

There will be an anonymous questionnaire at the end of the study that will be filled by you. The records of this questionnaire will be kept private. In any sort of report we make public, we will not include any information that will make it possible to identify you. Records will be kept confidential and only the researchers will have access to the records.

- **COMPENSATION**

Upon completion of interacting with our robot and filling out a short survey about your experience, you will be paid \$10 for your time.

- **TAKING PART IS VOLUNTARY**

Taking part in this study is completely voluntary. If you decide to take part, you are free to withdraw at any time. Your withdrawal will not attract any penalties towards you. You can stop by leaving the room. Any information about your interaction will be erased and deleted.

- **IF YOU HAVE QUESTIONS**

If you have any questions regarding your participation please feel free to contact the Principal Investigator, Dr. Casey Kennington at caseykennington@boisestate.edu. If you have any questions or concerns regarding your rights as a research participant in this study, or if you feel you have been placed at risk you may contact the Boise State University Institutional Review Board (IRB), which is concerned with the protection of volunteers in research projects. You may reach the board office between 8:00 AM and 5:00 PM, Monday through Friday, by calling (208) 426-5401 or by writing: Institutional Review Board, Office of Research Compliance, Boise State University, 1910 University Dr., Boise, ID 83725-1138. the IRB.

You will be given a copy of your form to keep for your records.

STATEMENT OF CONSENT

I have read this form and decided that I will participate in the project described above. Its general purposes, the particulars of involvement and possible risks have been explained to my satisfaction. I understand I can withdraw at any time.

Printed Name of Study Participant

Signature of Study Participant

Date

Signature of Person Obtaining Consent

Date